Internal Operations Platform – Phase 1 MVP

Estimated Timeline: 2 Weeks

Project Goal

Build a simple internal operations platform that replaces phone calls, text messages, and paper notes with one centralized system for dispatchers and drivers.

What We're Building

Dispatcher Dashboard

- Create and assign jobs
- Assign drivers, trucks, and dumpsters
- Update job status in real time
- Add job notes and instructions
- View completed jobs

Driver Dashboard

- View assigned jobs
- Receive real-time updates
- Open job addresses in Apple Maps
- Start and complete jobs
- Add notes
- Upload completion photos
- Clock in and clock out

Asset Management

- Track trucks and dumpsters
- View current assignment
- View last known job location
- Maintain equipment records

Equipment Tracking

For the MVP, we'll support **AirTags** as a low-cost solution for locating dumpsters when needed. The platform will also track each asset's operational location based on job assignments. In the future, dedicated GPS trackers can be integrated for live fleet tracking and advanced mapping features.

2-Week Development Timeline

Week 1

- Project setup
- Database design
- User authentication
- Dispatcher dashboard
- Job management
- Driver dashboard
- Real-time job updates

Week 2

- Time clock
- Truck & dumpster management
- Job photos and notes
- Testing & bug fixes
- Production deployment
- Team walkthrough and launch

Project Milestones

✅ Project architecture complete

✅ Dispatcher dashboard operational

✅ Driver dashboard operational

✅ Real-time job synchronization

✅ Time clock implemented

✅ Asset management complete

✅ Testing and quality assurance

✅ Live deployment and employee onboarding

Future Expansion

The platform will be built with future growth in mind, making it easy to add:

- Live GPS tracking
- Route optimization
- Customer portal
- Billing & invoicing
- Fleet maintenance
- Analytics & reporting
- AI-powered dispatching

Deliverable

At the end of the project, you'll have a secure, cloud-based operations platform that your dispatchers and drivers can use daily to manage jobs, communicate in real time, track employees, and organize trucks and dumpsters from one centralized system.

explain one by one what the items under future exansion mean to me so i can better explain to client

I actually think these future phases are one of the biggest selling points of your proposal. You're not just building an app—you're building the foundation of their own custom operating system. Here's how I'd explain each one.

Live GPS Tracking

What it means

Instead of just knowing what job a truck is assigned to, dispatch can actually see every truck moving on a live map.

Example

Austin opens the dashboard and immediately sees:

- Truck 3 is 6 minutes from the next job.
- Truck 5 is still at the landfill.
- Truck 2 hasn't moved in 30 minutes.

No phone calls required.

Route Optimization

What it means

The software automatically figures out the most efficient order to complete jobs.

Instead of dispatch planning routes manually, the system recommends the fastest schedule.

Benefits

- Less fuel
- Less driving
- More jobs completed each day
- Less overtime

Customer Portal

What it means

Customers get their own login.

Instead of calling the office they can:

- Request a dumpster
- Schedule pickups
- Check job status

- View invoices
- Upload photos
- Message dispatch

This reduces office workload significantly.

Billing & Invoicing

What it means

When a driver marks a job complete, the office can generate an invoice immediately instead of entering everything manually.

Eventually this could even happen automatically.

Benefits

- Faster payments
- Fewer mistakes
- Less office work

Fleet Maintenance

What it means

The system keeps track of truck maintenance.

Examples:

- Oil changes
- Tire rotations
- Brake service
- Registration
- Insurance
- DOT inspections

Instead of remembering dates, the software reminds the team when maintenance is due.

Analytics & Reporting

What it means

The software starts showing how the business is performing.

Examples:

- Number of jobs completed
- Revenue by week
- Most profitable customers
- Average response time
- Driver productivity
- Dumpster utilization
- Trucks sitting idle

Instead of guessing, management can make decisions using real data.

AI-Powered Dispatching

This is probably the coolest long-term feature.

Instead of dispatch making every decision manually, AI starts helping.

Examples:

Job Scheduling

AI says:

> "Truck 4 is already nearby. Assign this job there."

Route Suggestions

AI finds a faster route based on traffic.

Equipment Recommendations

AI says:

> "The customer requested a 30-yard dumpster, but based on similar jobs they usually need a 40-yard."

Staffing

AI notices:

> "Tomorrow has 18 scheduled jobs. You'll probably need one additional driver."

Predictive Maintenance

Instead of waiting for trucks to break down:

> "Truck 2 has reached 4,900 miles since its last oil change."

Business Insights

AI notices trends like:

> "Dumpster #14 hasn't been rented in 45 days."

or

> "Customer XYZ rents dumpsters every six weeks. It may be time to reach out."

Long-Term Vision

The exciting part is that **none of these future features require rebuilding the system**. Phase 1 establishes the core pieces—users, jobs, trucks, dumpsters, and workflows. Each later phase simply adds new capabilities on top of that foundation.

If I were pitching this to Austin, I'd end with something like:

> **"We're not trying to build everything at once. Phase 1 gives your team a reliable tool they can start using immediately. From there, we can continue**

> **evolving it into a custom operations platform that's built specifically for the way your company works."**

That frames the project as a long-term investment rather than a one-time software purchase.